



Industry News

GCC goes GPLv3

The Free Software Foundation (FSF), together with the GCC Steering Committee and the Software Freedom Law Centre, announced the release of a new GCC Runtime Library Exception. This licence exception will allow the entire GCC code base to be upgraded to GPLv3, and enable the development of a plug-in framework for GCC. "GCC includes runtime libraries that are automatically built into all the object code that GCC creates," explained Brett Smith, licence compliance engineer at the FSF. "Because we decided a long time ago to allow developers to compile proprietary software with GCC, these libraries have always had licence exceptions. This way, programs that are merely compiled with GCC don't have to be released under the GPL."

The text of the exception is available at www.fsf.org/licensing/licenses/gcc-exception.html. The FSF has also published a rationale document and FAQ at www.fsf.org/licensing/licenses/gcc-exception-faq.html to help users understand the exception better.

Azingo to create Vodafone's Linux apps

Vodafone has selected the open mobile OS company, Azingo, as a partner to develop applications for phones based on the LiMo platform. Both Azingo and Vodafone are core members of the LiMo (Linux Mobile) Foundation, which is an alliance started by Motorola, NEC, NTT DoCoMo, Panasonic Mobile Communications, Samsung Electronics and Vodafone in January 2007. Since then, a number of new members (like the Mozilla Foundation) have joined the alliance.

"We are excited to partner with Azingo to develop cutting-edge applications for our mobile phones based on the LiMo platform," said Guido Arnone, director, terminals technology, Vodafone. "We're looking forward to working with Azingo's agile development teams to develop and deliver innovative communications solutions for our customers."



HP bundles Blade PC and Citrix XenDesktop

HP and Citrix have announced a simplified solution that integrates affordable, high-performance HP Blade PCs and Citrix XenDesktop 3 to help businesses reduce costs and enjoy better manageability, scalability and security than with traditional PCs. "By combining HP blade PCs with XenDesktop, we've created a simple, low-cost virtualisation solution that helps companies efficiently manage and scale their computing environments while delivering the high-performance experience that knowledge and power users demand," said Roberto Motezuma, vice president and general manager, Desktop Solutions Organization, HP. "Particularly in this challenging economic environment, we see client virtualisation as a cost-efficient alternative for companies needing to economically update and better manage their personal computing infrastructures."

At the core of the solution are the new HP BladeSystem bc2800 Blade PC and HP BladeSystem bc2200 Blade PC, which offer advanced infrastructure control and scalability. These products are combined with Citrix XenDesktop 3 to provide a high-definition user experience and centralised desktop management. The combined offering leverages the power of both the data centre and endpoint devices to significantly reduce desktop TCO.

Bank of New Zealand deploys Red Hat on mainframes

Red Hat has announced that the Bank of New Zealand, a subsidiary of the National Australia Bank Group, has deployed Red Hat Enterprise Linux (RHEL) 5 on IBM System z mainframes to solve environment, space and cost issues related to its data centres. With Red Hat and IBM solutions, Bank of New Zealand has significantly reduced its hardware footprint, power consumption, heat and carbon emissions and costs, including an expected 20 per cent cost reduction over the life of the platform.

"Bank of New Zealand had defined two important goals for the future, both of which relied heavily on IT. The first was for the organisation to become carbon neutral by 2010 and the second was to explore open source opportunities through the adoption of Linux," said Lyle Johnston, infrastructure architect at BNZ. "We also faced the challenge of creating a disaster-recovery solution for our data centres in Auckland, New Zealand and East Melbourne, Australia."

In mid-2007, BNZ began overhauling its mission-critical front-end IT environment, including its Internet banking and bank teller functions, and its middleware layer providing connectivity through to its core back-end data. It migrated its systems to RHEL 5 running under z/VM on the mainframe. Today, BNZ utilises both IBM System z10 and z9 systems, exclusively running RHEL 5, to power the bank's customer-facing banking systems, including Internet banking and teller platforms. "We have also managed to substantially reduce our front-end power consumption by nearly 40 per cent, which means we are well and truly on our way to becoming carbon-neutral by our target year of 2010," said Johnston.

